



Sam Garland

NICK'S NEPHEW OR NIECE

Every mystery writer needs a plot. Tonight, you are in one.

FOR SAM GARLAND'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Nick's only family, and so his heir. A mystery writer who hasn't been published yet. Arrived on the evening train.

COSTUME

Easy: Cozy cardigan, notebook, scarf.
Go all out: literary chic: a chunky cable-knit cardigan, a tartan scarf, a fountain pen and a battered notebook.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your uncle, and your only family
- **Jamie Pudding:** you've heard Jamie and Nick were once a couple
- **Morgan Ivy:** you drew Morgan in the Secret Santa

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Collect material for your next novel from every guest
- Find out what Nick's will says
- Prove you're a writer, not a poisoner

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You're Nick's only family, so you're his heir. You write mystery novels that nobody has published yet. You arrived on the 6:05 train.

YOUR SECRET

You're deep in debt, and last month Nick refused to lend you money ("Get a real job, Sam"). Your notebook is full of research for your novel *Death by Mistletoe*, and that includes notes on poisonous plants. Foxglove is one of them.

You are innocent

Your alibi: your train didn't arrive until 6:05.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Sam



Your manner: Dramatic, curious and a little broke. Treat the whole night as research: scribble notes, gasp at clues, quote your own unpublished novel.

LINES TO TRY

- "This would make a marvellous chapter nine."
- "Uncle Nick never read a single page I wrote."
- "In my book, the butler did it. Is there a butler?"

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Laugh it off: "Writing about poison isn't the same as using it. I was on a train!"

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Be charming. Ask people whether Nick ever talked about his will. The cardigan by the fire is yours, and so is the notebook page in its pocket. If anyone asks, admit it: it's research for chapter 9, and you're a writer, not a poisoner. You haven't been near the greenhouse.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You arrived on the 6:05 train. Keep that in mind; it will matter later.
- Gossip: you've heard Nick and Jamie were a couple once.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan what happens to the company now Nick is gone.
- Ask Jamie how long they knew Nick, and how it ended.

MINI TASK

Interview three people "for your next novel" and note one suspicious thing each of them says.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Share something you noticed: at the 8:30 Secret Santa opening, when Nick held up a little bottle with a red ribbon and said "Peppermint! Someone knows me!", Robin looked away and went very quiet.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Nick drew you in the Secret Santa. His gift: a book called *How to Get a Real Job*. Laugh it off.
- You gave Morgan a fountain pen. Ask Morgan if they liked it.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan who had the greenhouse key this afternoon.
- Ask Jamie whether Nick said anything about his peppermint gift.

MINI TASK

With one other player, work out from the list who gave Nick the peppermint.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Casey Sleigh | ☐ Alex Snow |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3

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Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Admit the debt if pressed. Point out that the gardener's log means the foxglove was cut before 5:00, when you were still on the train.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- In your novel the poisoner is the butler. Real life is never that simple.
- Your train ticket proves you arrived at 6:05.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Frankie whether anything else was disturbed in the greenhouse.
- Ask Alex where they were before 7:15.

MINI TASK

Tell your theory, mystery-novelist style, to two people in under a minute each.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
Taylor Star · Hired Santa
Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
Casey Sleigh · Caterer
Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
Nick Frost · the victim